

First Winter in Central Ohio Checklist

Central Ohio winters swing: ice one week, mud the next. Use this before the first hard freeze — not during it.

Timing

When	Do this
Early November	Build car kit; test battery; locate ice scraper
Before first freeze warning	Disconnect / store hoses; check heat works in every room
First snow forecast	Clear porch/walk plan; confirm shovel / salt location
January thaw cycles	Re-check kit; replace used items

Car kit

- ☐ Ice scraper + brush
- ☐ Small shovel
- ☐ Bag of salt / sand / kitty litter for traction
- ☐ Jumper cables or jump pack
- ☐ Blanket + spare gloves/hat
- ☐ Flashlight + batteries
- ☐ Phone charger / power bank
- ☐ Bottled water + non-perishable snack
- ☐ Reflective triangle or vest
- ☐ Washer fluid rated for freeze temps
- ☐ Tire pressure check (cold weather drops PSI)

Winter tire / all-weather plan: _____

Where I park overnight: _____

Home / apartment kit

- ☐ Working heat tested in every room you'll use
- ☐ Draft blockers for leaky doors/windows
- ☐ Flashlights + batteries (or headlamp)
- ☐ Phone power bank charged
- ☐ 3-day shelf-stable food + water for household
- ☐ Medications refill before storms
- ☐ Snow shovel or building snow plan confirmed
- ☐ Ice melt for steps (pet-safe if needed)
- ☐ Know shutoff: water · furnace power · main breaker

Furnace filter last changed: _____

Building snow policy (renters): _____

Clothes that prevent misery

- ☐ Waterproof boots you can actually walk in
- ☐ Warm layers (not just a fashion coat)
- ☐ Gloves that work with a phone
- ☐ Backup socks in the car

After the storm

- ☐ Refill salt / restock snacks
- ☐ Check pipes along exterior walls if it was bitterly cold
- ☐ Note what you wished you'd had: _____

Buckeye Trail Guide · Curated by Keith Householder · Columbus, Ohio

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